WHANGĀREI EMERGENCY DEPARTMENT

# Using POCUS safely

Point of care ultrasound guidelines in the Emergency Department

- **Be credentialed or actively training.** If you're not yet credentialed, please enrol and participate in a recognised POCUS training programme, such as our local programme, ASUM or the Otago certificate.
- If you're **neither credentialed nor actively participating in POCUS training**, please wait until you have talked to an SMO and enrolled in some level of POCUS training before using the ultrasound machine.
- Unless you are an **SMO or credentialed in POCUS**, all POCUS imaging that affects patient care must be **reviewed by an SMO during or at the end of your shift, including night shifts.**
- If you are participating in POCUS training, including the local programme, and **no SMO is available to review your images**, please do not change your clinical management based on those findings. Obtain alternative imaging, or admit the patient for further imaging where clinically appropriate.
- **Document and save your scan.** Record the indication, findings, limitations, interpretation and who reviewed it in the clinical notes. Save the relevant images and clips for review, training and quality assurance.
- **Use appropriate probe covers for ultrasound-guided procedures.** Covers are kept behind the machine.

**A note on credentialing**
Credentialing involves completing learning modules, receiving shop-floor supervision and teaching, logging a prescribed number of scans, and demonstrating competency through observed scanning and supervisor sign-off. **Scan the QR code below for more details.**

**ACEM guidance**
These local guidelines are informed by current ACEM guidance on POCUS training and credentialing: P21 (v6) and P733 (v6.2). Local SMO review requirements apply.

## POCUS training APP

Learning • scan log • assessments • progress

point-of-care-pocus

Dr Mick Killeen · 20 October 2026